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# ‘It’s a bit too castle-y’: plans to turn Cumbrian fortress into eco-attraction

## Level 1: Elementary

## 1 Warmer

**a. Which place do you prefer to visit on holiday? Why? What do you want to do there?**

- Thailand
- Costa Rica
- Tanzania
- Australia

## 2 Key words

**a. Fill in the gaps in the sentences using these key words from the text.**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| castle | earn | eco-friendly | furniture | future |
| heat | hill | manage | mountain | single |

1. The energy that keeps a building warm is the _____.
2. A _____ is a large, strong building with thick walls, built to keep the people inside safe.
3. All of the chairs, beds, tables, etc. in a house are called _____.
4. If something is _____, it causes little or no harm to the environment.
5. A _____ person is not married and doesn’t have a romantic partner.
6. An area of land that is higher than the land around it but lower than a mountain is a _____.
7. A very high natural structure is a _____.
8. When you make the decisions about a team, project, or land, you _____ it.
9. The amount of money from a job or a business is the amount you _____.
10. The _____ is the time that is coming next but hasn’t happened yet.

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**b. Use some of the key words in part A to complete the sentences.**

1. She was the first woman to climb to the top of that _____.
2. Where do you want to travel in the _____?
3. There was so much _____ in their house that they couldn’t move!
4. This _____ makes it difficult to work. I prefer the winter.

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**Helen Pidd**

**26 February, 2023**

1 Ewan Frost-Pennington was born in 1990. Thirty years later, he moved back to his family’s 800-year-old castle. Now, he is trying to make Muncaster the first eco-friendly castle in the UK.

2 In early 2022, the 32-year-old was living and working in San Francisco. Now he makes a quarter of the money he did before and is living in a 14th-century building with his grandparents’ old furniture.

3 His new job at Muncaster is to make the castle’s 800 hectares (2,000 acres) not just eco-friendly but also a place tourists want to go.

4 It is far from big cities – an hour off the M6 motorway and two hours from Manchester Airport. So, it can be difficult to attract tourists. Frost-Pennington is planning to have shows, concerts and even a 10km race there.

5 Living in a castle with his parents can be difficult for a young, single man (his US girlfriend came with him from California but did not stay).

6 The castle has a lot of history, so he cannot make many changes. He cannot hang his own pictures and it is very cold most of the time. 60 per cent of the heat that the castle uses comes from the sun or underground.

7 Out of his bedroom window, Frost-Pennington can see the hills of Eskdale, with Scafell Pike, England’s highest mountain, in the distance.

8 Muncaster Castle has been in his family for at least 800 years. Frost-Pennington’s mother, Iona, has managed it since she was 23. Her parents and grandparents sold the family silver and most of the 12,000 hectares to keep the castle.

9 Sometimes the castle’s tourist business earns less than £10,000 a year. Iona Frost-Pennington pays herself just £3,000 a year. Still, Ewan wants to show that he can bring more tourists to visit.

10 Waving us goodbye, Frost-Pennington says he is happy about the article and hopes that he doesn’t hurt the castle’s future.

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## 3 Comprehension check

**a. Answer the questions using information from the article.**

1. What year was Ewan Frost-Pennington born?
2. How old is the castle?
3. Where is Muncaster Castle?
4. What is Frost-Pennington trying to do?
5. How old is Ewan Frost-Pennington at the time of the article?
6. Where did he live before Muncaster?
7. How far is Muncaster Castle from Manchester Airport?
8. Who does Frost-Pennington live with at the castle?
9. What can he see from his bedroom window?
10. How much money does Muncaster’s tourist business earn in a year?

## 4 Key language

**a. Match each word to its opposite.**

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. early | a. married |
| 2. future | b. lowest |
| 3. far | c. polluting |
| 4. highest | d. past |
| 5. single | e. near |
| 6. eco-friendly | f. late |

## 5 Discussion

**a. Discuss these statements.**

- “We should all travel in an eco-friendly way because it helps the earth.”
- “All homes and buildings should use solar power (energy from the sun).”

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### 6 In your own words

**a.** **Search online to find more information about eco-friendly travel. Find some places to go on holiday and what you can do there. You can use one of the locations from the Warmer exercise if you want.**

**b.** **Report your findings to the class.**

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